

tions which had caused their transfer thither) that they were no longer movable. The re-transferred section accordingly began with 7:73.

The result was (as we have the best of evidence) that *two editions* of the Chronicler's book, with its interpolated Story of the Youths, were current at the beginning of the Christian era. The two differed only at one point, namely, the section Neh. 7:73—10:40, containing the story of the Reading of the Law and the account of the Sealing of the Covenant. In the one edition (call it A) the position of this section was the same as in our massoretic Hebrew Bible; in the other edition (call it B) it had been appended to the Book of Ezra, of which it formed the close, Ezra 10:44 being continued by Neh. 7:73; and in neither edition were the two narratives which constitute this section in their original and proper context! To describe the two editions a little more fully:

A = I and II Chron.; history from Cyrus to the completion of the temple as in I Esdr.; stories of Ezra and Nehemiah as in our Hebrew Bible.

B = I and II Chron.; history from Cyrus to the completion of the temple as in I Esdr.; story of Ezra concluding with Neh. 7:73—10:40; story of Nehemiah as in our Hebrew Bible *minus* the section just mentioned.

One point in the description of Edition B requires special proof here, namely, the statement that not only Neh. 8, but also chaps. 9 and 10, were retransposed to the end of Ezra. That chap. 8 was thus transferred we know, of course, from First Esdras. Our only surviving text, however, breaks off at the beginning of vs. 13, in this chapter; so for an answer to the question, What came next? we must turn to other evidence. This is of two kinds:

1. *General probability*.—Chaps. 9 and 10 had long been connected with chap. 8, and must have been felt to be of one piece with it. Whoever had acumen enough to see that chap. 8 was out of place in the Book of Nehemiah must also have seen (as readers of the book in all ages have seen) that chaps. 9 and 10 belonged with equal certainty to the story of Ezra. The testimony of such verses as 9:1-3, 4 f. (cf. 8:4, 7); 10:28(!), 29,